



CIA REPORT

"General B.M. Kaul told US ambassador John Galbraith that the Indian Army viewed the Chinese as set in a mood for weakness and would take maximum advantage of this mood by establishing even more posts. The Indian Army was in no mood to be pushed around."

"Defence Minister Krishna Menon said in 1962 that Indian military positions in Ladakh were untenable, Indian forward posts would be wiped out...the Chinese could push the Indians far beyond their 1960 claim."

contention. "For a while in fall (autumn) 1959 Nehru seemed to be preparing the Indian public for cession of the Aksai Plain (Aksai Chin) to the Chinese in exchange for Indian ownership of the NEFA (now Arunachal Pradesh), but this view was opposed by some leaders in the Congress party."

The papers also provide some insights into the Tibetan issue, which has often been seen as a leveraging point for India vis-a-vis China. However even though Nehru provided political



FACE OFF: Indian and Chinese troops clash, (below) Menon

asylum to Dalai Lama and his supporters, despite Chinese protests in 1959, they also indicate this uneasiness with hosting the Dalai Lama. Did Nehru want to shun the Tibetan cause, and ask the Dalai Lama to leave; the report says that he had privately said so. "For Nehru, who on the one hand was compelled by the presence of Dalai Lama on Indian soil to defend him and on the other hand was reluctant to further strain Sino-Indian relations, he told the Tibetan leader to limit his activities in India to religious affairs, and Indian officials were probably reflecting Nehru's real anxiety when they stated privately that the government would not be sorry to see the Dalai leave the country," the report claims.

India's military miscalculations are also much in evidence. The CIA papers reveal that the Indians were caught on the wrong foot and had completely miscalculated their strength vis-a-vis the Chinese. After the failure of talks, Indians had adopted a forward policy of establishing as many frontier posts along the disputed border resulting in many clashes with the Chinese army.